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Video Response

After watching Chandra Arthur's talk on "The Cost of Code-Switching", I feel that she conveyed how she acted in different groups growing up and how that changed her view on social acceptance. I found that Chandra often referenced past experiences to show how she learned to act in specific scenarios in ways that were seen as acceptable. She did this through reflection on her experiences at the gifted school a town over when she was young. For example, she states that she couldn't be too "ghetto" while at school, but didn't talk about classical music at home as she wished to remain "culturally compatible" in both contrasting groups (Arthur). She also talks about how she originally dressed differently from the other kids at school and was even told her hair was not appropriate for the setting.

This TedTalk goes back to the ideas of transfer and literacy we have reviewed so far in ENC 1101 as "code switching" talks about going between two types of literacy. For instance, Arthur talks about how she talked differently at home than she did in a professional setting, showing different rules apply for literacy in different situations. Furthermore, her reflections on early experiences in school support the idea of transfer as her current way of thinking was shaped by what she learned early in life.

I would argue that this TedTalk is a literacy narrative as she talks about being an effective communicator, which is the main component of literacy. When she references her use of "y'all" at a business meeting and it being seen as unprofessional, she highlights the contrasts that exist in literacy. She then discusses the idea of a society where people are accepting of different types of literacy in different situations.

Work Cited

Arthur, Chandra. "The Cost of Code-Switching." *TEDx Talks*, YouTube, 22 Aug. 2017.